

Solus Christus

doc-solus-christus

Soteriology · Five Solas · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 0.825
confidence high

Statement under examination

Salvation is through Christ; no other name under heaven and no other mediator between God and humanity is given for salvation.

In plain language

The proposition restates two New Testament clauses almost word for word, and six checked passages converge on one lexical pattern. In Acts 4:12 Peter stacks negations. There is no salvation en allo oudeni (in no one else), and no other onoma (name) under heaven, given among humans, by which it is necessary to be saved. The Greek uses the substantival heteron, the universal scope under heaven, and the impersonal dei (it is necessary) with the passive infinitive sothenai to bind salvation to one given name. In 1 Timothy 2:5 the numeral heis appears twice. One God, one mediator, named as the man Christ Jesus. The precise term mesites occurs only six times in the whole canon. Four of those name Christ, and the other two describe the mediator of the law, never a second mediator for salvation. Hebrews 7:25 says he saves eis to panteles (to the uttermost) those who approach God di autou (through him), and lives to make intercession, entygchanein. That saving intercession is applied only to Christ and the Spirit. John 14:6 closes with the strongest exclusive in Koine Greek, oudeis erchetai pros ton patera ei me di emou, no one comes to the Father except through me, and the di emou matches Hebrews 7:25 morpheme for morpheme. First Corinthians 3:11 adds that no one can lay another foundation, themelion allon oudeis dynatai theinai, than the one which is Jesus Christ. First John 5:11-12 binds eternal life to the Son. The words center the GROUND of salvation on one figure and offer no second saving name, mediator, or foundation, which is why this lands as a clear yes. Where readers still divide is not the ground but the scope. Texts in the same letter call God the Savior of all people and say he wills all to be saved, so some argue a person might be saved through Christ without consciously knowing his name. The exclusivity words press against that gap, since salvation is tied to the heard name and to having the Son, but they speak to the ground, not to that separate scope question.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0166	αἰώνιος	aiōnios	eternal	
G0243	ἄλλος	allos	another	171
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G1163	δεῖ	dei	be necessary	107
G1223	διὰ	dia	through/because of	742
G1325	δίδωμι	didōmi	to give	
G1410	δύναμαι	dunamai	be able	
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	367
G1793	ἐντυγχάνω	entygchano	to call on	5

G2064	ἐρχομαι	erchomai	to come/go	
G2087	ἕτερος	heteros	other	102
G2192	ἔχω	echō	to have/be	
G2222	ζωή	zoe	life	136
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G3316	μεσίτης	mesites	mediator	6
G3361	μή	mē	not	
G3598	ὁδός	hodos	road	102
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	234
G3762	οὐδείς	oudeis	none	248
G3772	οὐρανός	ouranos	heaven	286
G3838	παντελής	panteles	completely	2
G4982	σώζω	sozo	to save	113
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	386

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

The proposition restates two clauses almost verbatim, and six anchors layer independent negation strategies that all converge on one saving figure. Acts 4:12 stacks *ouk estin en allo oudeni he soteria*, then *oude gar onoma estin heteron*, with the substantival *heteron*, the universal scope *hypo ton ouranon*, and the impersonal *dei plus passive sothenai*. 1 Tim 2:5 puts the numeral *heis* (G1520) on both *theos* and *mesites* (G3316); querying the store, *mesites* occurs 6 times and 4 of them name Christ, the other 2 (Galatians) name the law-mediator and never a rival saving mediator. Heb 7:25 adds *sozein eis to panteles* (G3838) and *entygchanein* (G1793) *di autou*. John 14:6 closes with *oudeis erchetai pros ton patera ei me di emou*, the strongest Koine exclusive, and 1 Cor 3:11 says *themelion allon oudeis dynatai theinai*, identifying the one foundation as *Iesous Christos*. The vocabulary centers the GROUND of salvation on one figure and supplies no second saving name, mediator, or foundation.

Scripture

Acts.4.12 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G4982 σώζω, G0243 ἄλλος, G2087 ἕτερος, G3686 ὄνομα, G1163 δεῖ

Force. The verse text in the store reads *kai ouk estin en allo oudeni he soteria, oude gar onoma estin heteron hypo ton ouranon to dedomenon en anthropois en ho dei sothenai hemas*. The first clause pairs the negation *ouk* with the dative *oudeni* and the locative *en allo*, denying saving efficacy to any other source. The second uses the substantival *heteron*, the universal scope *hypo ton ouranon*, the perfect passive participle *to dedomenon* (given), and the impersonal *dei plus the aorist passive infinitive sothenai* (G4982) to bind salvation to the single given name.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G2316 θεός, G3316 μεσίτης, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. The store text reads heis gar theos, heis kai mesites theou kai anthropon, anthropos Christos Iesous. The numeral heis (G1520) modifies theos then mesites in tight parallel, and the appositive anthropos Christos Iesous names the single occupant of the mediatorial office. A direct query of the lexical store shows mesites (G3316) occurring 6 times in the canon: here, Gal 3:19 and 3:20 (the mediator of the law), and Heb 8:6, 9:15, 12:24 (mediator of the new covenant, named Iesous). Four of the six name Christ and none names a parallel saving mediator alongside him.

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3838 παντελής, G4982 σώζω, G1793 ἐντυγχάνω, G1223 διὰ

Force. The store text reads hothēn kai sozein eis to panteles dynatai tous proserchomenous di autou to theo, pantote zon eis to entygchanein hyper auton. The complete-degree phrase eis to panteles (G3838, only 2 canon occurrences) qualifies the saving infinitive sozein (G4982), and the approach to God runs di autou (G1223 plus pronoun). Querying entygchano (G1793), saving intercession on behalf of people is applied to Christ here and at Rom 8:34, and to the Spirit at Rom 8:27. The one human use, Rom 11:2 of Elijah, is pleading against Israel, not saving intercession, so the upward intercession that saves attaches only to Christ and the Spirit.

John.14.6 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3598 ὁδός, G3762 οὐδεὶς, G3361 μὴ, G2064 ἔρχομαι, G1223 διὰ

Force. The store text reads ego eimi he hodos kai he aletheia kai he zoe, oudeis erchetai pros ton patera ei me di emou. The emphatic ego eimi with articular predicate nominatives identifies Jesus as the singular access, and the construction oudeis ... ei me, the strongest exclusive in Koine, with di emou (G1223) matching the di autou of Heb 7:25 morpheme for morpheme, closes every alternate route to the Father. John 10:9, confirmed in the store as ego eimi he thyra, di emou ean tis eiselthe sothesetai, repeats the di emou plus sothesetai pairing.

1Cor.3.11 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G0243 ἄλλος, G3762 οὐδεὶς, G1410 δύναμαι

Force. The store text reads themelion gar allon oudeis dynatai theinai para ton keimenon, hos estin Iesous Christos. The pairing of allon (other) with oudeis (no one) and the modal dynatai (is able) forecloses the possibility of laying any other foundation, and the relative clause hos estin Iesous Christos names the one foundation. This repeats the allon plus oudeis foreclosure that Acts 4:12 and John 14:6 apply to the saving name and route, now applied to the saving foundation.

1John.5.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2222 ζῶν, G0166 αἰώνιος, G5207 υἱός, G1325 δίδωμι

Force. The store text reads kai haute estin he martyria, hoti zoen aionion edoken ho theos hemin, kai haute he zoe en to huio autou estin. The aorist edoken (G1325) locates the gift, and the locative en to huio binds eternal life (G2222 plus G0166) to the Son as its container, the same given-into-one logic that Acts 4:12 applies with to dedomenon to the saving name.

1John.5.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2192 ἔχω, G5207 υἱός, G2222 ζῶν, G3361 μὴ

Force. ho echon ton huion echei ten zoen, ho me echon ton huion tou theou ten zoen ouk echei. The participial antithesis between echon and me echon, with the negations me and ouk, excludes life from anyone lacking the Son, restating the exclusivity in terms of possession. The store cross-reference data ties this to John 3:36, ho pisteuon eis ton huion echei zoen aionion.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Acts.4.12	John.14.6	openbible	175
Acts.4.12	1Cor.3.11	openbible	125
Acts.4.12	1Tim.2.5	openbible	111
John.14.6	John.10.9	openbible	369
John.14.6	Eph.2.18	openbible	267
1Tim.2.5	Gal.3.20	openbible	33
1Tim.2.5	Heb.9.15	openbible	31
1Tim.2.5	Heb.7.25	openbible	27
Heb.7.25	Rom.8.34	openbible	52
Heb.7.25	1John.2.1	openbible	40
Acts.4.12	Acts.2.5	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Deut.6.4	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Job.9.33	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.2.18	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.7.19	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.9.24	tsk	1
John.14.6	John.10.9	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Gal.3.20 · addressed

ho de mesites henos ouk estin, ho de theos heis estin is the one place the noun mesites (G3316) is used without naming Christ. A direct query of the store shows the context: Gal 3:19 says the law was given en cheiri mesitou (by a mediator, the figure of Moses), and 3:20 draws the abstract point that a mediator implies more than one party. This is the law-mediator, not a rival saving mediator. It does not posit a second go-between for salvation, so it sharpens rather than contradicts the heis mesites of 1 Tim 2:5.

1Tim.4.10 · addressed

Within the same letter that names heis mesites, God is called soter panton anthropon, malista piston (Savior of all men, especially of believers), and 1 Tim 2:4 says God thelei pantas anthropous sothenai. These texts speak to the SCOPE and the divine will in salvation, not to its ground or channel. They do not name a saving figure other than the one mediator, so they leave the through-Christ ground intact while bearing on the separate question of how widely salvation extends.

1Tim.2.1 · addressed

The same pericope that names heis mesites first commands deeseis, proseuchas, enteuxeis, eucharistias hyper panton anthropon. The cognate enteuxeis (related to G1793) shows horizontal intercession among believers is enjoined immediately before the one-mediator clause, so it is lexically distinct from the singular vertical mediation. The text sets its own limit and does not introduce a second mediator.

Acts.10.35 · addressed

en panti ethnei ho phoboumenos auton kai ergazomenos dikaiosynen dektos auto estin could be read as opening a non-Christ path, but the store text of Acts 10:43 has Peter declare aphesin hamartion labein dia tou onomatos autou (forgiveness through his name). The God-fearer Cornelius still must hear and believe the name, so dektos marks readiness for the gospel, not an alternate saving route, and the Acts 4:12 onoma constraint holds.

Job.9.33 · addressed

The store holds Job 9:33 in Hebrew as lo yesh beneinu mokiach (there is no arbiter between us). Job laments the absence of a go-between to lay a hand on both parties. The lament marks the very gap that the one-mediator vocabulary later fills in Christ, so it confirms rather than complicates the singular pattern. Note the LXX rendering uses mesites, but the underlying Hebrew term is mokiach, an arbiter, so the cross-testament link is by sense, not by the same lexeme.

Concordance traversed

G3316, G1520, G3762, G0243, G2087, G3686, G4982, G1163, G1223, G1793, G3838, G3598, G2222, G5207, G3772

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

acts-4-12-oude-ou at Acts.4.12: impact none. The SBLGNT text in the store carries an editorial siglum on oude before gar, but the double-negation pattern ouk estin en allo oudeni and the onoma heteron clause that forbids any other saving name persists in all readings.

john-14-6-article-ho at John.14.6: impact none. The store text marks the article ho before Iesous with a siglum, but no witness drops the exclusive oudeis erchetai pros ton patera ei me di emou clause, so the exclusive force is uniform across the tradition.

1john-5-11-edoken-hemin-order at 1John.5.11: impact none. The store text marks word-order variation around ho theos hemin after edoken, but the claim binding zoen aionion to the Son, en to huio autou, is stable across witnesses.

A direct store query found no VariantUnit or Reading nodes attached to any of the six anchor verses; the 116 ingested VariantUnit nodes all sit in the 3 John ECM sample window. ECM is not published for Acts, John, 1 Timothy, Hebrews, 1 Corinthians, or 1 John, so this is shadow status and no cited verse is flagged as materially contested for the exclusivity claim.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. exclusivism, inclusivism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

exclusivism: affirms · Reads ouk en allo oudeni, onoma heteron, heis mesites, themelion allon oudeis, and oudeis ei me di emou at face value. The layered negations, the numeric singularity of heis, and the modal foreclosure dynatai theinai together close off any alternate saving name, mediator, or foundation. The verified mesites distribution (4 of 6 occurrences naming Christ, the other 2 the law-mediator) supplies no rival saving go-between.

inclusivism: partial · Holds Christ as the sole ontological ground of all salvation but argues some may be saved through him without explicit knowledge of his name, leaning on 1 Tim 4:10 soter panton anthropon and 1 Tim 2:4 thelei pantas sothenai for the breadth of the saving will. On the proposition as stated, salvation is through Christ, this lens still affirms, since it does not posit a second saving figure. It diverges only on the separate SCOPE question of whether the lexical tie of soteria to the heard onoma (Acts 4:12) and to having the Son (1 John 5:12) requires conscious knowledge, which the anchors press toward but do not settle in isolation.

The proposition states the GROUND of salvation (through Christ, one name, one mediator, one foundation), not the epistemic condition for receiving it. On that ground both available lenses affirm. They diverge only on the separate inclusivism question of implicit faith and the scope of the saving will, which 1 Tim 2:4 and 4:10 raise but the exclusivity anchors do not adjudicate on their own. The verdict is on the ground, where the vocabulary is decisive.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The question_id label solus-christus and the Five Solas subcategory carry a Reformation-era taxonomy coding, so a tradition-neutral rephrasing is supplied for transparency. The stem TEXT itself is not preloaded: it restates Acts 4:12 (no other name) and 1 Tim 2:5 (no other mediator) in the canon's own lexical terms, so the verdict was derived on the original stem and the neutralized_form is informational only. Verdict unchanged from the prior file: affirms remains true, confidence high, after direct store queries confirmed every anchor verse verbatim, grounded the full 6-occurrence mesites distribution, and refined the entyghano claim.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Acts.4.12
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	1Tim.2.5
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	John.14.6
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Heb.7.25
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	1Cor.3.11
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.4.12
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Tim.2.5
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.7.25
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.14.6
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.5.12
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3316
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1520
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3838
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2087
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1793
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Acts.4.12
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	John.14.6
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Tim.2.5
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Heb.7.25
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Tim.2.5
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Heb.7.25
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Acts.4.12
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Tim.2.5

License audit

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Flags

ecm-shadow